DSA MS Current-Student Survey Collection

Short and expanded instruments for academic support, curriculum improvement, and career outcomes

Prepared October 8, 2026. Draft instruments for faculty review.

Contents

1. Shorter surveys

2. Expanded surveys

3. Completion-time comparison and design notes

These are two alternative sets of five surveys. Choose the shorter or expanded version for each collection moment; do not routinely ask students to complete both. The recurring current-student check-in is separate. Applicants, near-graduation collection, and graduate surveys are outside this collection.

Section 1. Shorter surveys

S1. Beginning of the Program

When: During the first two weeks of the student's first semester. **Estimated time:** 4-5 minutes.

Introduction: Help us understand your starting point, goals, and support needs as you begin the DSA MS program.

1. **What was your primary undergraduate field of study?** Short text; allow Other or Prefer not to answer.

2. **How much experience do you have in each area?** Matrix: Python programming; SQL and relational databases; statistics and probability; linear algebra; data cleaning and analysis; data visualization. Scale: No experience / Introductory exposure / Can complete basic tasks independently / Can complete advanced tasks independently.

3. **Have you been told that you need to complete any prerequisites or preparation activities?** Yes / No / Unsure. If Yes: Which remain incomplete? Optional short text.

4. **In which areas would you most benefit from introductory support?** Select all: Programming; databases and SQL; mathematics; statistics; using development tools; academic writing or communicating results; study strategies or time management; unsure; other (optional text); no introductory support needed (exclusive).

5. **What are your main goals for completing this program?** Select up to three: Begin a career in data science or analytics; advance in my current career; change careers; prepare for further study or research; apply data skills within another field; develop technical skills; explore career possibilities; other (optional text).

6. **Which career areas currently interest you?** Select all: Data analysis or business intelligence; data science or machine learning; data engineering or database work; research; applying data science in a specific industry; still exploring; other (optional text). Optional: Specify an industry or role.

7. **What do you most want to learn or accomplish during your first semester?** Optional short text.

8. **Which resources would help you get started?** Select all: Preparation materials or refresher exercises; tutoring or academic support; course-planning guidance; software and tool setup; career information; classmates or a study group; university support-service information; unsure; other (optional text); none at this time (exclusive).

S2. Beginning of a Semester

When: During the first two weeks of each semester. **Estimated time:** 3-4 minutes.

Introduction: Help us understand your plans for this semester and any support you may need to carry them out.

1. **Which semester of the DSA MS program are you beginning?** First / Second / Third / Fourth or later.

2. **Which DSA courses are you taking this semester?** Select all from the current course list; include Enrollment not finalized.

3. **Are there any prerequisites or foundational skills you still need to strengthen for these courses?** Yes / No / Unsure. If Yes or Unsure: Programming; databases and SQL; mathematics; statistics; data analysis; other (optional text); I need help identifying the gaps.

4. **What are your main goals for this semester?** Select up to three: Strengthen foundational skills; complete planned courses; complete a portfolio project; gain research experience; explore career options; prepare internship applications; apply for internships; prepare job applications; apply for jobs; other (optional text).

5. **Approximately how much time can you usually reserve for coursework outside scheduled classes each week?** Fewer than 5 hours / 5-9 / 10-14 / 15-19 / 20 or more / Unsure.

6. **Are any commitments likely to affect your participation this semester?** Optional, select all: Paid work; caregiving or family responsibilities; transportation or commuting; scheduling conflicts; reliable computer or internet access; other commitments; prefer not to answer; none anticipated (exclusive).

7. **Has your career direction changed since your last profile update?** Yes / No / I am still exploring. If Yes: Describe your current direction (optional text).

8. **What support would help you accomplish your semester goals?** Select all: Academic preparation or tutoring; course or program planning; project or research guidance; career exploration; resume, portfolio, or interview preparation; internship or job-search guidance; university support referrals; unsure; other (optional text); none at this time (exclusive).

S3. Advising Milestones

When: Before a scheduled advising meeting or an important academic planning decision. **Estimated time:** About 3 minutes.

Introduction: Tell your adviser what you would like to address so the meeting can focus on your priorities.

1. **What is the main reason for this advising update?** Routine academic planning; choosing or changing courses; reviewing prerequisites; difficulty in a course; project or research planning; career direction; considering an enrollment change; follow-up on earlier advising; other (optional text). Select one.

2. **Which topics would you like to discuss?** Select all: Course selection or sequencing; academic progress; foundational skill gaps; study strategies or academic resources; project or research opportunities; internship or career preparation; commitments affecting study; university support resources; other (optional text).

3. **Is anything preventing you from following your current academic plan?** Yes / No / Unsure. If Yes or Unsure: Describe the issue, sharing only what you are comfortable providing (optional text).

4. **If you previously agreed on action items with an adviser, what is their status?** All completed / Some completed / In progress / Not started / Need clarification / No previous action items. Optional: Which item needs discussion or support?

5. **What decision or outcome would make this advising discussion useful to you?** Optional short text.

6. **When would you like a response or meeting?** Within the next few business days / Within the next two weeks / At my next scheduled advising meeting / No additional meeting requested.

7. **Is there anything else your adviser should know beforehand?** Optional short text.

S4. Internship or Job-Search Milestones

When: Beginning a search, applying, interviewing, receiving an offer, or beginning an opportunity while enrolled. **Estimated time:** 3-4 minutes.

Introduction: Update us on your career progress so the program can offer relevant support. Answer for your current search or opportunity.

1. **What are you currently pursuing?** Internship / Full-time job / Part-time job involving data skills / Multiple opportunity types / Career exploration / Not currently pursuing an opportunity. If not pursuing: Skip to Questions 7-8.

2. **Which stage best describes your current progress?** Exploring roles or industries; preparing applications; identifying opportunities; submitting applications; interviewing or completing assessments; considering an offer; accepted but not started; started an internship or job; paused the search.

3. **Which roles or industries are you targeting?** Optional short text.

4. **When do you hope to begin?** Within three months / In three to six months / More than six months / Already started / Unsure.

5. **Since your last career update, or since beginning this search, what steps have you completed?** Select all: Updated resume; updated portfolio; sought advice or attended a career event; contacted employers or professional connections; submitted applications; completed interviews or assessments; received an offer; accepted an offer; started the opportunity; no steps yet (exclusive).

6. **What is making progress difficult?** Select all: Unclear direction; finding suitable opportunities; limited experience or portfolio; application preparation; interview or assessment preparation; limited connections; time constraints; location or work arrangement; eligibility requirements; unsure; other (optional text); no current difficulty (exclusive).

7. **What career support would be useful now?** Select all: Identifying roles or employers; opportunity listings; resume review; portfolio review; interview or assessment practice; networking guidance; discussing an offer; fitting an internship with coursework; unsure; other (optional text); none (exclusive).

8. **Would you like faculty or adviser follow-up about your career plans?** Yes / No. Optional: What would you most like help with?

S5. End-of-Semester Curriculum and Career Feedback

When: After coursework is completed, ideally after final grades are posted. **Estimated time:** 8-12 minutes as originally proposed; allow 12-20 minutes for three courses in planning (see Section 3).

Introduction: Help us improve the DSA MS curriculum, preparation resources, and career opportunities. Focus on learning, course connections, and career goals. Written responses are optional. Avoid naming classmates or sharing their personal information.

Part A. Repeat for each course

1. **Which course are you reviewing?** Select from the semester course list.

2. **How well did prior knowledge prepare you?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Well / Very well.

3. **Would a prerequisite or preparation requirement have helped?** Required prerequisite course / Refresher, workshop, or module / Both / Existing requirements sufficient / No requirement needed / Unsure. If preparation needed: (a) Select needed skills: Python; other programming; SQL/databases; statistics; linear algebra; calculus; data cleaning; visualization; machine learning; development tools; technical communication; other. (b) Name a recommended course or activity (optional). (c) Were these needs communicated before enrollment? Yes / Partly / No / Unsure.

4. **How did this course connect with other courses?** Select all: Built on earlier work; useful reinforcement; repetition without added depth; assumed untaught knowledge; better earlier; better later; unclear connections; insufficient experience to judge. Optional: Identify topic, overlapping course, or sequence change.

5. **How much did this course develop each area?** Matrix: Technical knowledge; realistic open-ended problem solving; messy/incomplete data; nontechnical communication; collaboration; responsible data practices; independent tool learning. Scale: Not at all / A little / Somewhat / Quite a bit / A great deal / Not applicable.

6. **Did the course produce work you could show an employer?** Ready to share / With revision / Possibly, with guidance / No / Unsure. Optional: What would make it portfolio-ready? Do not include restricted data or materials.

7. **What would most improve its learning and career value?** Select up to three: Preparation resources; realistic data/problems; relevant tools; underlying concepts; open-ended projects; documentation/presentation guidance; nontechnical communication; teamwork with shared tools; industry examples; course coordination; assignment/goal alignment; other; no major changes (exclusive).

8. **What should the department preserve or change?** Two optional text fields: Preserve / Change.

Part B. Across the program

9. **Were there important gaps or unnecessary overlaps this semester?** Gaps / Overlaps / Both / Neither / Unsure. Optional: Identify topics and courses; distinguish useful reinforcement from repetition.

10. **How manageable was major-assignment timing across courses?** Consistently / Usually / Occasionally difficult due to clustering / Frequently difficult due to clustering / Took one course. Optional: Suggest a coordination change.

11. **Which areas need more attention for your career goals?** Select up to three: Programming/software practices; SQL/data engineering; statistics/experimental design; machine learning/evaluation; real-world data;

visualization/communication; deployment; responsible AI/privacy/ethics; domain knowledge; teamwork; portfolio; career exploration/employer connections; other; unsure; no additional areas (exclusive).

12. **Have you applied this semester's learning outside class?** Select all: Internship; paid work; research; personal project; community project; interview/assessment; other; no opportunity (exclusive). If applicable: What was useful and what preparation was missing? Optional text.

13. **What would better connect coursework to careers?** Select up to three: External projects; employer/alumni connections; skill-to-role explanations; portfolio guidance; interview/assessment practice; opportunity access; research/applied projects; elective guidance; other; unsure; current opportunities sufficient (exclusive).

14. **What single change would be most valuable for future students?** Optional text.

15. **Would you discuss your feedback further?** Yes / No.

Section 2. Expanded surveys

L1. Beginning of the Program

Purpose: Establish preparation, expectations, career goals, and support needs. **When:** First two weeks. **Estimated time:** 12-15 minutes; broad range 8-22.

Introduction: Your responses will help the DSA MS program understand your starting point and provide relevant academic and career support. You may skip optional questions.

A. Background

1. **What was your primary undergraduate field of study?** Short text.

2. **Have you completed other relevant degrees, certificates, or substantial training?** Yes / No. If Yes: Describe subject and type (optional text).

3. **What relevant experience do you bring?** Select all: Data-analysis coursework; data/technology employment; internship; research; personal projects; community projects; no experience; other. Optional: Describe one experience representing your abilities.

B. Preparation

4. **Rate your experience in each area.** Matrix: Python; SQL/databases; statistics/probability; linear algebra; calculus; data cleaning/analysis; visualization; machine learning; Git/version control; command-line/development environments; technical communication. Scale: No experience / Some exposure / Basic tasks independently / Advanced tasks independently / Unsure.

5. **Which activities have you completed?** Select all: Data-processing program; SQL query; cleaning missing/inconsistent data; statistical analysis; training/evaluating a model; communicating through visualization; team project with shared tools; explaining findings to a nontechnical audience; none.

6. **Have you been assigned prerequisites or preparation activities?** Yes / No / Unsure. If Yes, repeat for each: Course/activity; status (Completed / In progress / Not started); help needed (Yes / No / Unsure).

7. **Which subjects need additional preparation?** Select from Question 4, plus None and Unsure.

8. **Which preparation formats would help?** Select all: Tutorials; workshops; exercises with solutions; tutoring; peer groups; prerequisite course; faculty office hours; unsure; other.

C. Goals and expectations

9. **Main reasons for the degree?** Up to three: Enter data career; advance career; change career; doctoral study/research; apply data in another field; technical expertise; explore careers; other.

10. **Roles of interest?** Select all: Data analyst; business intelligence analyst; data scientist; machine-learning engineer; data engineer; database role; research; other; still exploring.

11. **Industries or application areas of interest?** Optional text.

12. **What should the program help you develop?** Up to five: Mathematics/statistics; programming; data management; machine learning; realistic problem experience; research; portfolio; communication; teamwork; professional connections; internship opportunities; career/job-search skills.

13. **What would make your first year successful?** Optional text.

14. **Are requirements, sequencing, or career possibilities unclear?** Yes / No / Unsure. If applicable: What needs clarification? Optional text.

D. Access and support

15. **Do you have reliable access to needed resources?** Matrix: Suitable computer; internet; software/computing environments; study space; reserved coursework time. Scale: Yes / Sometimes / No / Unsure.

16. **What circumstances should the program consider in planning?** Optional, select all: Employment; caregiving; commuting; scheduling; financial constraints; technology access; other; prefer not to answer; none.

17. **What support would help?** Select all: Preparation; course planning; software setup; study strategies; peer connections; career exploration; university resources; other; none.

18. **Would you like follow-up?** Yes / No. If Yes: Topic (optional text).

L2. Beginning of a Semester

Purpose: Update plans and identify preparation and career needs. **When:** First two weeks of each semester. **Estimated time:** 10-15 minutes for about three courses; broad range 7-22.

Introduction: Help us understand your plans and what could help you succeed. Confirm prefilled information and update anything that has changed.

A. Semester plan

1. **Which semester are you beginning?** First / Second / Third / Fourth or later.

2. **Which courses are you taking?** Current course list; Enrollment not finalized.

3. **How clear is each course's place in your program plan?** Very unclear / Somewhat unclear / Neither / Somewhat clear / Very clear.

4. **Concerns about the sequence?** Select all: Needed course unavailable; schedule conflict; unsure what comes next; taking a course before prepared; repeated content; elective guidance needed; other; none.

B. Repeat Questions 5-8 for each course

5. **How prepared are you for expected starting knowledge?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Well / Very well / Unsure what is expected.

6. **Which areas need review?** Select all: Programming; SQL/databases; statistics; linear algebra/calculus; data cleaning; machine learning; development tools; technical communication; other; unsure; none.

7. **Were expected skills and prerequisites clear before enrollment?** Yes / Partly / No / Did not review them.

8. **What preparation would help?** Select all: Expected-skill list; refreshers; exercises; workshop; tutoring/study group; instructor/adviser discussion; other; none.

C. Goals and progress

9. **Three highest priorities?** Up to three: Courses; foundations; portfolio; research; teamwork/communication; career exploration; internship preparation; internship applications; job preparation; job applications; other.

10. **Progress on previous goals?** Repeat each saved goal: Completed / Partly completed / In progress / Not started / No longer relevant. Optional: What helped or prevented progress?

11. **Planning an applied experience this semester?** Yes / No / Exploring. If applicable: Type of activity; desired skills; help needed finding or defining it.

12. **Has your career direction changed?** Yes / No / Still exploring. If applicable: Updated roles/industries (optional text).

D. Time and support

13. **Weekly coursework hours outside class?** Fewer than 5 / 5-9 / 10-14 / 15-19 / 20-24 / 25 or more / Unsure.

14. **Circumstances affecting plans?** Optional, select all: Employment; caregiving; commuting; scheduling; technology; finances; other; prefer not to answer; none.

15. **Do you have required software, equipment, and access?** Yes / Partly / No / Unsure. If applicable: What is missing? Optional text.

16. **Useful support?** Select all: Preparation/tutoring; course planning; projects/research; career planning; portfolio; internship/job search; study strategies; referrals; other; none.

17. **What decision or concern should an adviser address early?** Optional text.

18. **Would you like follow-up?** Yes / No.

L3. Advising Milestones

Purpose: Prepare for advising, track actions, and assess results. **When:** Before discussion, with follow-up afterward. **Estimated time:** Before: 8-12 minutes (range 5-18). After: 3-5 minutes (range 2-8).

Introduction: Tell your adviser what to address and what progress you have made. Share only personal context you are comfortable providing.

A. Before the discussion

1. **What prompted this update?** Select all: Academic planning; course selection; prerequisites; course difficulty; project/research; career planning; internship planning; enrollment change; earlier-discussion follow-up; other.

2. **Most important priority?** Optional text.

3. **Which decisions need help?** Select all: Courses/electives; course load; preparation gaps; academic progress; project/research direction; career connections; internship fit; continuing/pausing/changing enrollment; other; none.

4. **Is your academic plan achievable now?** Yes / Partly / No / Unsure. If applicable: What needs adjustment? Optional text.

5. **Barriers to progress?** Select all: Foundations; course material; unclear requirements; availability/sequencing; time; technology; opportunity access; personal circumstances to discuss privately; other; none.

6. **Resources already tried?** Select all: Instructor office hours; adviser; tutoring; study group; tutorials/practice; career services; university services; other; none. Optional: What helped and what remains unresolved?

B. Earlier actions

7. **Were action items agreed previously?** Yes / No / Unsure / No previous discussion. If Yes, repeat each: Action; status (Completed / In progress / Not started / No longer applicable); clarity (Yes / Partly / No); obstacle (optional text); further help (Yes / No / Unsure).

8. **Did previous advising help you move forward?** Not at all / A little / Somewhat / Quite a bit / A great deal / Not applicable. Optional: What was useful or missing?

C. Desired outcome

9. **What would make this discussion successful?** Select all: Course plan; skill-development plan; referral; project/research step; career direction; barrier-resolution plan; requirements clarification; other.

10. **When would you like a response?** Few business days / Within two weeks / Next scheduled meeting / No extra meeting.

11. **Anything else your adviser should know?** Optional text.

D. After the discussion

12. **Were main questions addressed?** Fully / Mostly / Partly / Not at all.

13. **How clear are next steps?** Very unclear / Somewhat unclear / Neither / Somewhat clear / Very clear.

14. **Were next steps realistic?** Yes / Partly / No / No actions agreed.

15. **Anything unresolved?** Yes / No. If Yes: Optional description.

16. **What could improve advising?** Select all: Scheduling; pre-meeting information; continuity; course guidance; career guidance; clear actions; follow-up; referrals; other; no change needed.

L4. Internship or Job-Search Milestones

Purpose: Understand progress, obstacles, employer expectations, and support needs. **When:** Meaningful career changes while enrolled. **Estimated time:** 10-15 minutes; broad range 5-22.

Introduction: Update your career activity to help the program support you and understand how coursework prepares students for opportunities.

A. Goals and stage

1. **What are you pursuing?** Internship / Full-time job / Part-time data work / Multiple types / Exploration / Not pursuing. If not pursuing: Skip to Questions 15-17.

2. **Current stage?** Exploring; preparing materials; identifying openings; applying; interviews/assessments; considering offer; accepted/not started; started; paused.

3. **Target roles and industries?** Two optional text fields.

4. **Desired start?** Within three months / Three to six months / More than six months / Already started / Unsure.

5. **Requirements affecting opportunities?** Optional, select all: Location; work arrangement; schedule; compensation; duration; eligibility; coursework compatibility; other; prefer not to answer; none.

B. Past 30 days

6. **Applications submitted?** 0 / 1-5 / 6-10 / 11-20 / More than 20 / Unsure.

7. **Employers with whom you interviewed or completed assessments?** 0 / 1-2 / 3-5 / More than 5 / Unsure.

8. **Offers received?** 0 / 1 / 2 or more / Prefer not to answer.

9. **Useful opportunity/contact sources?** Select all: Faculty/staff; career services; classmates/alumni; events; networking; job boards; employer websites; prior employers; other; none yet.

C. Skills and obstacles

10. **Skills employers requested?** Select all: Python; SQL; statistics; machine learning; cleaning; visualization/BI; engineering/cloud; software practices; communication; teamwork; domain knowledge; other; not reached this stage.

11. **How well has coursework prepared you for encountered requirements?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Well / Very well / Insufficient experience. Optional: One strength and one gap.

12. **Most useful course, project, or assignment, and why?** Optional text.

13. **Obstacles?** Select all: Direction; openings; experience; portfolio; applications; assessments; interviews; connections; time; location/work arrangement; eligibility; little feedback; other; none.

14. **What employer feedback could improve preparation?** Optional text. Summarize without naming interviewers or sharing confidential assessment content.

D. Support

15. **Useful support?** Select all: Direction; listings; resume; portfolio; interviews; assessments; networking; offers; internship/coursework planning; other; none.

16. **Next planned career step?** Optional text.

17. **Would you like faculty/adviser follow-up?** Yes / No.

E. Accepted or started opportunity only

18. **Opportunity type?** Internship / Full-time / Part-time / Other.

19. **Role title and industry?** Two optional text fields; employer name not required.

20. **How closely does it relate to DSA learning or goals?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Closely / Very closely / Unsure.

21. **If started, which skills have you used?** Select from Question 10, plus Not started and None yet.

22. **What would have made you better prepared?** Optional text.

23. **How could the department support similar opportunities?** Optional text.

L5. End-of-Semester Curriculum and Career Feedback

Purpose: Improve prerequisites, sequencing, coverage, applied learning, and career preparation. **When:** After coursework, ideally after grades. **Estimated time:** 25-35 minutes for three courses; broad range 18-50.

Introduction: Explain how courses fit together and support your development. Focus on specific experiences and constructive suggestions. Written comments are optional; avoid naming classmates or sharing their information.

A. Repeat Questions 1-13 for each course

1. **Which course?** Semester course list.

2. **How well did prior knowledge prepare you?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Well / Very well.

3. **Which necessary starting skills were insufficiently developed?** Select all: Programming; SQL/databases; statistics; linear algebra; calculus; cleaning/analysis; machine learning; development tools; technical communication; other; no substantial gaps.

4. **Would different preparation requirements have helped?** Prerequisite course / Refresher module / Both / Clearer expected skills / Existing requirements sufficient / No requirement needed / Unsure. If change suggested: Specific prior content; suggested course/activity; point when gap became apparent (three optional text fields).

5. **If you completed listed prerequisites, did they prepare you adequately?** Fully / Mostly / Partly / Not at all / Did not complete / None listed / Unsure. Optional: What was missing?

6. **Curriculum connections?** Select all: Built on earlier work; useful reinforcement; repetition without depth; assumed untaught material; unclear connections; better earlier; better later; insufficient experience. Optional: Related courses/topics and suggested change.

7. **Depth of coverage?** Too introductory / Somewhat introductory / Appropriate / Somewhat advanced / Too advanced / Varied by topic. Optional: Topics needing more or less depth.

8. **How well did assignments demonstrate learning goals?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Well / Very well / Unsure. Optional: Mismatch or effective assignment.

9. **Which tools or methods did you use meaningfully?** Optional text; distinguish substantive use from demonstrations.

10. **How much did the course develop each area?** Matrix: Technical knowledge; open-ended problem solving; messy data; method selection/evaluation; reproducibility; documenting decisions; nontechnical communication; collaboration; ethics/privacy/limitations; independent tool learning. Scale: Not at all / A little / Somewhat / Quite a bit / A great deal / Not applicable.

11. **How closely did assignments resemble employment or research problems?** Not at all / Slightly / Moderately / Closely / Very closely / Unsure. Optional: How to make them more realistic?

12. **Did you produce evidence of your skills?** Ready to share / With revision / Possibly with guidance / No / Unsure. Optional: Help needed to make it portfolio-ready.

13. **What should be preserved or changed?** Three optional fields: Preserve; change; highest-priority change and expected benefit.

B. Curriculum across courses

14. **Important gaps or unnecessary duplication?** Optional text naming topics/courses and distinguishing reinforcement from repetition.

15. **Would you change course or topic sequence?** Yes / No / Unsure. If Yes: Proposed sequence and reason (optional text).

16. **Combined assignment timing?** Consistently manageable / Usually manageable / Occasionally difficult due to clustering / Frequently difficult due to clustering / One course. Optional: Coordination improvement.

17. **Areas needing attention?** Up to five: Programming/software; databases/engineering; statistics/design; machine learning/evaluation; real-world data; communication; deployment; responsible AI/privacy/ethics; domain knowledge; teamwork/project management; research methods; portfolio; career preparation; other; unsure; none.

18. **Desired electives or applied experiences?** Optional text connecting suggestions to goals.

C. Application outside class

19. **Did you apply learning outside class?** Select all: Internship; employment; research; personal project; community work; interview/assessment; other; no opportunity. If applicable: Useful learning; missing skills; course/activity to address the gap (three optional text fields).

20. **How much did the semester clarify suitable career roles?** Not at all / A little / Somewhat / Quite a bit / A great deal.

21. **Better career connections?** Up to three: External projects; employer/alumni participation; skill-to-role links; portfolio; interview/assessment practice; opportunities; research/applied projects; career-oriented elective pathways; other; unsure; current connections sufficient.

D. Department priorities

22. **Resources used and their helpfulness?** Matrix: Advising; office hours; tutoring/preparation; career guidance; projects/research; peer learning; computing/software. Scale: Not helpful / Slightly helpful / Moderately helpful / Very helpful / Did not use / Unaware of availability.

23. **Support needed but inaccessible?** Optional text.

24. **Single most valuable change for future students?** Optional text.

25. **One departmental strength to preserve?** Optional text.

26. **Would you discuss feedback further?** Yes / No.

Section 3. Comparison, timing, and design notes

Completion-time comparison

Planning estimates, not observed timings. Assume careful reading, brief optional comments, and functioning conditional logic. Semester estimates assume approximately three courses.

Collection moment	Shorter version	Expanded typical time	Expanded broad range
Beginning of program	4-5 minutes	12-15 minutes	8-22 minutes
Beginning of semester	3-4 minutes	10-15 minutes	7-22 minutes
Advising: before meeting	About 3 minutes	8-12 minutes	5-18 minutes
Advising: after meeting	No separate follow-up	3-5 minutes	2-8 minutes
Internship/job-search milestone	3-4 minutes	10-15 minutes	5-22 minutes
End of semester, three courses	12-20 minutes*	25-35 minutes	18-50 minutes

*The shorter end-of-semester survey was originally described as 8-12 minutes. Because eight questions repeat for each course and include a matrix and conditional comments, 12-20 minutes is a more cautious planning allowance for three courses. Neither estimate has been tested.

For expanded advising, completing both stages typically totals 11-17 minutes, split across two occasions. A student not pursuing a career opportunity receives only Questions 1 and 15-17 of L4 and may finish in approximately 2-4 minutes. This short path is outside the usual estimate for active searchers.

Effect of course count

For L2, allow roughly 1-2 minutes per course for the repeated preparation section, plus time for semester planning and support questions. Additional goals or preparation concerns increase the time.

For L5, use 5-8 minutes per course plus 8-12 minutes for program-wide questions:

Courses reviewed	Expanded end-of-semester estimate
1	13-20 minutes
2	18-28 minutes
3	23-36 minutes
4	28-44 minutes

The 25-35 minute typical estimate for three courses is a rounded planning estimate within the calculated 23-36 minute range. Detailed comments can push completion beyond these ranges.

Why the expanded questions are useful

Survey	Added detail	Decision it supports
Beginning of program	Practical experience, specific foundations, expectations, resource access	Preparation resources, initial advising, career direction
Beginning of semester	Preparation per course, previous goals, sequence concerns	Early support, elective guidance, course availability and sequencing
Advising	Action-by-action status and post-meeting feedback	Clearer next steps, continuity, referral and follow-up improvements
Career milestones	Recent activity, employer requirements, applied skills	Search support, portfolio development, employer connections, curriculum relevance
End of semester	Prerequisite adequacy, duplication, depth, application and resource use	Curriculum coordination, preparation requirements, applied learning, career services

Relationship to the project document

The source framework recommends collection at the beginning of the program, beginning of a semester, advising milestones, and internship/job-search milestones. These surveys translate those moments into proposed instruments. The end-of-semester survey is an additional collection point requested during planning.

The framework's under-three-minute limit applies specifically to the recurring current-student check-in, not to these milestone surveys. Its broader principles still apply: keep forms purposeful, collect only information faculty can use, preserve information over time, and use transparent indicators. These instruments are proposals, not verbatim requirements or validated research scales.

Implementation and administration

- Use the shorter and expanded versions as alternatives. Avoid administering both versions for the same event.

- At first enrollment, combine overlapping beginning-of-program and beginning-of-semester questions, rather than collecting the same background twice.

- Prefill known account, course, and goal information, allowing corrections. Link submissions to students and store timestamps automatically; preserve earlier responses.

- Use conditional follow-ups. Label single-select, multi-select, selection limits, and matrix scales clearly. Make None, Unsure, and Prefer not to answer exclusive where they conflict with substantive responses.

- All narrative responses are optional. Personal circumstances and eligibility questions should allow skipping or Prefer not to answer. Do not require sensitive explanations.

- Add a faculty-approved notice describing purpose, identifiable access, retention, and use before live collection. Do not promise anonymity for an account-linked survey. For course feedback, consider collecting after grades and showing aggregate findings where feasible.

- Define who monitors follow-up requests, how often they review them, and what response students can expect. Timing choices express preferences, not guaranteed service deadlines.

- Use semantic headings, visible labels, keyboard-accessible controls, and clear error messages in implemented forms. The HTML supplied here is a readable survey specification, not a live submission system. The PDF is a reading copy, not a fillable form.

- For longer instruments, allow save-and-resume and show progress. Separate before- and after-advising collection; allow course sections to be completed independently when possible.

- Keep identifiable information in the secured application. De-identify any text before AI processing, as the project framework requires.

Interpretation and pilot testing

Self-reported preparation is not a skills test. Application and interview counts describe activity, not student quality; opportunity availability and individual circumstances affect results. Student suggestions about prerequisites should prompt review alongside syllabi, learning objectives, and performance patterns, rather than automatically creating enrollment barriers.

Review patterns across students and semesters, particularly in small cohorts. Avoid treating one comment as a departmental conclusion. Keep support requests actionable and separate them from aggregate improvement reporting where practical.

Pilot each instrument with a few current students. Measure completion times, inspect confusing options and skipped items, and ask which questions felt repetitive. Revise estimates and remove questions that do not inform a concrete decision. The end-of-semester instruments need particular timing review because their length scales with course count.

Source and provenance

Source framework: DSA MS Student Success System: 10-Week Design and Implementation Framework, dated September 7, 2026, supplied as DSA_MS_Student_Success_10_Week_Project (1)(1).pdf. Relevant sections: 6 (Privacy, ethics, and AI), 7 (Data the system should collect), and 8 (MVP capabilities). Survey wording and timing estimates were developed in this conversation on October 8, 2026. Wording has been lightly standardized for consistent export; core questions, choices, and branching are retained.